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Abstract

This article explores the relationship between solicitation messages posted by nonprofit organizations on their Facebook profile and attracting donations during online fundraising events. Recent studies suggest that certain types of messages are more effective at spurring donors to give, but the evidence base is founded mainly on experimental designs. We use observational data for 752 nonprofits that participated in one or both of the Omaha Gives fundraising events in 2015 and 2020. Using the total amount of money donated to each organization as our outcome, we find nonprofits that post more diverse solicitation messages raise more money during online fundraising events. Consistent with previous studies, social media network size, activity, and engagement are once again important factors in explaining fundraising success. Our results provide deeper insights into the nuances of social media strategies for attracting donors and raising funds.

Keywords

Fundraising, social media, online giving, giving days, Facebook

Introduction

It is common knowledge that nonprofit organizations harness the power of social media platforms to connect with potential donors, share their work, recruit volunteers, and raise donations (Campbell et al., 2014; Guo & Saxton, 2014, 2020; Lovejoy & Saxton, 2012; Waters et al., 2009; Waters & Jamal, 2011). In the past decade, fundraising using social media has been one of the fastest ways of collecting donations from individuals globally (Global Trends, 2020). Similarly, academic studies have found evidence that an *active* social media presence - such as nonprofits posting requests for donations on Facebook - can lead to peer pressure among “friends” of a donor or followers of the nonprofit and acts as a motivation for them to give (Bhati & McDonnell, 2020; Castillo et al., 2014; Harris et al., 2021; Lacetera et al., 2016; Saxton & Wang, 2014).

However, still there is a gap in our understanding about what type of social media activities, and solicitation requests in particular, are most successful at generating donations (Saxton & Waters, 2014; Xiao et al., 2022). For instance, studies have shown that not all messages are equal in attracting donations through traditional fundraising practices (Huang et al., 2016; Guidry et al., 2014; Saxton & Waters, 2014). This leaves important questions unanswered: what type of messaging on social media generates the highest level of donations? Should nonprofits adopt a diverse or consistent approach to their solicitation messages when raising funds through social media platforms? To answer these questions, we use data from 752 nonprofits that participated in the Omaha Gives online fundraising events in 2015 and 2020. We link administrative data on these organisations, including total donations received, to their social media usage, in particular their Facebook posts in relation to Omaha Gives in the lead-up to the events. We find a

moderate, statistically significant relationship between message type diversity and fundraising success: nonprofits that post a diverse range of messages on social media – e.g., thanking donors for their support, sharing information about the organization’s mission, demonstrating impact on beneficiaries – to solicit donations raise more in funding than organizations that post homogeneous solicitation messages. We also find, compared to posts aimed at general solicitation, posts focused on gratitude or goal attainment are associated with increased donations. Finally, social media network size, activity, and engagement are once again important factors in explaining fundraising success. Our study is one of the first to show the influence of message type and diversity on fundraising success during giving days using observational data on a large sample of nonprofit organizations.

Literature Review

Since the early 2000s, nonprofit organizations have evolved in their usage of Information Technology from an era where only a handful of organizations had a website and communication was mainly “one-way” (Hackler & Saxton, 2007; Kang & Norton, 2004), to more reciprocal (“two-way”) engagement (Bortree & Seltzer, 2009; Briones et al., 2011; Lovejoy & Saxton, 2012). As nonprofits continue to use social media platforms, scholars have focused on how nonprofits are using them to engage with stakeholders. Lovejoy & Saxton (2012) identified a three-tier “hierarchy of engagement”: the first tier as providing *information* about the organization or cause, followed by developing a *community*, and finally calling on followers to *act* on behalf of the organization. Subsequent studies have implemented this framework to advance the understanding of social media usage by nonprofits in diverse contexts (Bürger, 2015; Campbell & Lambright, 2020; Svensson et al., 2015; Zhou & Pan, 2016). Overall, these

studies argue a majority of organizations still use social media platforms primarily for disseminating information, with limited communication and engagement focused on community building or calls to action.

Another important stream of research examines the relationship between social media usage, such as the frequency of posting messages and subsequent engagement with followers, and attracting donors and donations (Bhati & McDonnell, 2020; Elvira-Lorilla et al., 2023; Enjolras, 2023; Lee, 2021; Olinski & Szamrowski, 2021; Saxton & Wang, 2014; Suh, 2022; Sun & Asencio, 2019). Although these studies provide valuable insights about the relationship between social media usage and fundraising, they do examine which type of fundraising messages are most successful at generating support. This question is essential as nonprofits are fiercely competing to get attention from potential donors (Guo & Saxton, 2018).

A small number of studies examine whether the content of social media messages is associated with attracting donations. In an experimental study, Baek & Yoon (2022) found that participants expressed a higher intention to give when fundraising appeals on social media triggered a particular emotion. For example, participants show higher intention to give when they are shown ads focusing on egoistic benefits (i.e., benefits to the donor). Similar results were found by Daniel, Curley & Walk (2024) examining social media fundraising messages. They found “donors most positively responded to the philanthropic or altruistic attempts to raise funds” (p. 79). In another experimental study using participants from Amazon MTurk, Xiao et al. (2022) found that messages containing details on outcomes produced by donations elicited higher intention to donate. These studies suggest that message content influences prosocial behavior in the relation

of social media. However, the research on this topic is nascent and founded on experimental studies and/or small samples. Our study addresses this gap by using observational data on nonprofit's social media messages and their subsequent success during online fundraising events.

Data and Method

Our data consists of 983 observations for 752 nonprofits that participated in one or both Omaha Gives fundraising events in 2015 and 2020. 231 of these 752 organisations participated in both events (2015 and 2020) and 521 nonprofits participated in one Omaha Gives. Omaha Gives was a 24-hour fully online, community-wide event in the Omaha Metro area organized by Omaha Community Foundation (OCF). The event took place for eight consecutive years between 2013 and 2020 and raised over \$58 million for local nonprofits (OCF, 2021). In Omaha Gives 2015 and 2020, a total of 1,720 nonprofits participated (2015 – 704 and 2020 – 1,016). However, only 752 organizations either received any donations or had a social media presence that we could measure. All participating organizations created a public profile at omahagives.org where donors can donate as little as \$10 through the website. Throughout the 24 hours, the total amount raised is publically accessible using the Omaha Gives portal, and participating nonprofits can continuously appeal to potential donors through their social media platforms.

The data underpinning this study records total donations received by the organization, its program service area and budget size, as well as Facebook information on the number of likes, posts, shares, and message content and diversity. While the social media landscape evolves at pace, Facebook remains an important platform for nonprofits (Carboni & Maxwell, 2015; Campbell & Lambright, 2020). We collect social media data using a three-stage process. First,

we collected all Facebook posts by each organization from their profile in the months leading up to each event (including the day it took place). Second, we filter posts to those containing terms related to Omaha Gives, such as “Omaha Gives,” “omahagives,” “#omahagives,” “omaha gives,” “omahagives!,” and “May 20.” Third, Facebook posts were hand coded into distinct message types drawn from previous literature on fundraising messaging (Table 1). Each post was assigned a single code based on the message types listed in Table 1; in instances where a post appeared to fit multiple categories, codes were assigned after considering the post’s primary focus (Lovejoy & Saxton, 2012; Saxton & Waters, 2014). Further, any discrepancies between coding were discussed and code rules were refined until an agreement was reached by the researchers.

Table 1: Categories of fundraising posts by organizations participating in Omaha Gives

Category	Explanation	Example
Beneficiaries	Focus of the post is discussing how organization is helping its beneficiaries by naming them (Duncan, 2004; Smith & McSweeney, 2007)	@NebraskaMed Your donation to #OmahaGives helps our Child Life team take care of patients like Abby! Donate today: bit.ly/1IREaG7
Goal attainment	Motivating donors to give by targeting a fundraising goal (Cryder, Loewenstein, Seltman, 2013; Dai & Zhang, 2019)	@YCBinc Thank you everyone!!! We made it to \$4,245.00!!!! This is a great accomplishment. Your donations are going directly to help teens and adults with disabilities. Can we make it to \$5,000? You can help!!!
Gratitude	Posts focusing on thanking donors for their donations (Li et al., 2020; Waters & Feneley, 2013)	@nebraskaculturalendowment We are feeling the love! Thank you Ree & Jun, Heidi, Sharee & Murray, John & Judy and Matt & Kristi to for your generous gifts to the NCE through #OmahaGives! There is still plenty of time to give during this community #givetoegether. May 20th is #OmahaGives! Give to the NCE at http://bit.ly/1zT1d1g

Mission	Focus of the post is discussing organizations' mission and how it helps its beneficiaries (Milde & Yawson, 2017)	@ ZPHIBNebraska Did you know that Omaha Gives! is less than a month away?! This year consider making a gift to the Nebraska Sigma Zeta Education Foundation (Nebraska Sigma Zeta Education Foundation, Inc.) as we spread awareness about the importance of prenatal care and Stork's Nest, our #1 prenatal education program! The program provides incentives and encouragement for women to keep prenatal appointments, a critical factor for helping babies get a healthy start in life. Your gift will help us keep two Omaha metropolitan area locations open as we continue to serve more women, families and babies!
Social media engagement	Engaging with donors by requesting them to change their profile picture on Facebook or share fundraising message with their friends (Castillo et al., 2014)	@WIFCaP2 If you have, or if you are going to donate to Omahagives24.org on behalf of WIFCaP on Wednesday May 20th (two days away!) feel free to make one of these cool #OmahaGives profile pics yours, from now thru the 20th! We would love to see LOTS of WIFCaP logo's out there supporting our cause! Thank you!
Solicitation	Overall focus of the post is sharing details and persuading donors to give (Bekkers & Wiepking, 2011)	@62649475309 Omaha Gives is a 24-hour charitable challenge to benefit metro area non-profits. This community "give together" begins at midnight on May 20 with a minimum gift of only \$10. There will be hourly drawings, prizes, and bonus dollars to boost your gifts. Ask your friends, families, and co-workers to join the fun. On May 20 go to omahagives24.org and donate to CrossOver Prison Ministries.

Analytical Approach

Our dependent variable is the total donations (\$) raised by a participating nonprofit during an Omaha Gives event. Drawing on past studies, we operationalize ten independent variables: five relating to organizational characteristics and five concerning social media use. Budget size is

measured using an ordinal variable with three categories: (1) budget size less than \$250,000 (Small); (2) budget between \$250,000 - \$999,999 (Medium); and (3) budget more than \$999,999 (Large). Organization age is calculated by subtracting year of each Omaha Gives event from the nonprofit's year of formation. Prior participation in Omaha Gives is measured as a binary categorical variable - 1 if the organization participated in past Omaha Gives and 0 if it is its first time. Program service area is a nominal variable with nine categories representing areas of activity, including Human Services, Religious, Education, Arts & Culture, etc. Finally, we employ a binary variable to measure the difference in donations for the 2015 and 2020 events (1 = donations raised during 2020, 0 = donations raised during 2015).

We specify three numeric measures of social media usage: (1) total likes on nonprofits's Facebook page (*network size*), (2) total number of posts related to Omaha Gives (*network activity*), and (3) total shares of posts relating to Omaha Gives by the organization's Facebook followers (*network engagement*). We operationalize fundraising message content as a categorical measure capturing the most common (modal) Facebook post type based on our classification: Beneficiary, Goal, Gratitude, Mission, Social Media, Solicitation, and Tie (which captures instances where a nonprofit has more than one most common post type e.g., same number of Mission and Gratitude posts). For example, a nonprofit has total of 8 Facebook posts, 4 were coded as Gratitude (50 percent of total posts), 2 were coded as Goal, 1 was coded as Mission and 1 was coded as Social Media; in this instance Gratitude is the most common post type. Finally, we measure fundraising message diversity as a continuous variable ranging between 0 (very concentrated post types) and 1 (very diverse post types). For example, a nonprofit that only posts Solicitation messages will have a score of 0, while an organization that posts an equal number of all post types will have a score of 1.

We employ ordinary least squares (OLS) regression with cluster-robust standard errors on a log-transformed version of total donations: the transformation ensures that our regression coefficients fall within the valid range of the dependent variable (i.e., nonzero, positive values for total donations). Cluster-robust OLS, which adjusts statistical significance tests in light of some organisations appearing more than once in the data, is preferred to panel data models with organisation fixed-effects as only 231 of 752 organisations provide observations for more than a single year and thus there is little variation over time in the data. Fixed-effects models only examine *within-unit* variation in the outcome; in this instance the model coefficients could only be interpreted in terms of how organisations change over time, not differences between them. We estimate our models in an iterative process, adding in the organizational characteristic variables, followed by our three numeric measures of Facebook use, and finally, our measures of Facebook post type – we examine the statistical significance of adding in each set of variables using Likelihood Ratio tests. We test for multicollinearity among the independent variables in each model by calculating the variance inflation factors (VIF): mean VIF is never higher than 1.5 and no variable has a VIF greater than 2.5 in any model which is below the thresholds of suggesting multicollinearity is not a problem (Allison, 1999).

Results

Sample Description

The mean and median donations raised per nonprofit organization was \$11,969 (SD=\$29,644) and \$3,395 respectively, with this amount ranging from \$2 to \$419,624. The mean age of participating nonprofits was 32 years (SD = 33). Approximately 50 percent of organizations had an annual budget of less than \$250,000, while 28 percent had a budget size of \$1 million or

greater. 60 percent of nonprofits participated in past Omaha Gives events. Finally, participating nonprofits covered diverse program service areas: human services (24 percent) was largest, followed by education (17 percent), and arts & culture (14 percent).

The total number of likes on an organization's Facebook page ranged from 1 to 269,382; 50 percent of organizations had 1,300 or fewer likes. The number of Facebook posts participating nonprofits made relating to Omaha Gives ranged from 1 to 80, with a mean and median of 7 (SD=8) and 5, respectively. The number of shares of posts related to Omaha Gives by nonprofits' followers ranged from 0 - 2,249, with a mean of 23 (SD=12) and median of 6; 25 percent of organizations had 2 or fewer shares.

Table 2. Summary statistics for dependent and independent variables

Variable	N	Median	Mean	SD	Minimum	Maximum
Total donations	983	\$3,395	\$11,969	\$29,6449	\$2	\$419,624
Organisation age	983	21	32	33	1	184
Network size (no. of likes)	983	1,300	3,939	12,902	1	269,382
Network activity (no. of posts)	983	5	7	8	1	80
Network engagement (no. of shares)	983	6	23	112	0	2,249
	N	%				
<i>Budget size</i>						
Small (< \$250,000)	453	46				
Medium (\$250,0000 - \$999,999)	251	26				
Large (> \$1 million)	279	28				
<i>Program Service area</i>						
Arts & Culture	142	14				
Education	169	17				
Environment / Animal	44	4				
Health	132	13				
Human Services	234	24				
Community Improvement/Social Advocacy	98	10				

Religious	115	12
Neighborhoods	21	2
Other	28	3
<i>Post type</i>		
Beneficiary	24	2
Goal	25	3
Gratitude	35	4
Mission	126	13
Social Media	8	1
Solicitation	653	66
Tie	112	11
<i>Past participation</i>		
No	407	41
Yes	576	59
<i>Year</i>		
2015	491	50
2020	492	50

Notes: Figures rounded to nearest whole number and therefore percentages may not round to 100.

Predicting Donations using Message Content and Diversity

We present the results of a set of nested statistical models predicting total donations as a function of our independent variables. The models are estimated on a consistent sample of 752 organizations (983 observations) with no missing values for the variables of interest. We describe the regression coefficients as the percentage change in total donations for a given change (absolute or percentage) in the independent variables e.g., an x percent increase in the number of Facebook post shares is associated with a y percent increase in total donations.¹ We interpret Model 3 coefficients to make substantive claims about the association between each of the independent variables and the outcome – this model was chosen as it constitutes a better fit

¹ The calculation for independent variables in their original scale: $(\text{exponent}(\text{model coefficient}) - 1) * 100$, which produces the percentage change in the outcome for a one-unit change in the independent variable. The calculation for independent variables in their log scale: $(1.10^{\text{model coefficient}} - 1) * 100$, which produces the percentage change in the outcome for a percentage change in the independent variable.

for the data compared to the other two models as per the statistically significant likelihood ratio tests, and encompasses organizational characteristic variables, measures of Facebook use, and our measure of Facebook post type.

Age is not associated with fundraising performance during Omaha Gives: the predicted level of total donations does not vary substantially across organizations of different ages (e.g., newer vs. older). There is a clear gradient in the association between budget size and total donations: medium (between \$250,000 and \$1mn) and large (over \$1mn) organizations are predicted to raise 79 percent ($\exp(0.580)$, $p < .001$) and 265 percent ($\exp(1.296)$, $p < .001$) more than small organizations respectively. Nonprofits participating in Omaha Gives 2020 raised 29 per cent less in expected donations compared to organizations taking part in the 2015 event. Finally, there is considerable variation by program service area: compared to human service organizations, neighborhood nonprofits raised over 100 percent more and health nonprofits 17 percent less.

There are statistically significant, positive relationships between each of the numeric measures of social media usage and total donations. We find a 2.2 percent increase in donations for a 10 percent increase in the number of likes on participating nonprofit's Facebook profile. Similarly, a 10 per cent increase in the number of posts or the times a post is shared is associated with predicted increases in donations of 3 percent and 1.4 percent, respectively. There are variable – both in terms of the magnitude of the coefficients and their statistical significance - differences in expected donations by Facebook post type: compared to organizations that most commonly use general solicitation posts, organizations that rely most heavily on messages relating to gratitude or goals raised 59 and 78 percent more in donations respectively, while those that relied mainly

on posts calling on followers to behave a certain way on Facebook, e.g., change their profile picture (Social Media) raised 58 percent less. One explanation for the latter could be that donors do not feel the need to donate as they have already taken “action” by changing their profile picture. Nonprofits that have more than one most common type of post raised 10 percent more those that mainly post general solicitation posts.

Table 3. Regression Analyses of Total Donations in Omaha Gives 2015, 2020

Table 3: Linear Regression Models of Total Donations (Log), Coef. (SE)						
	Model 1		Model 2		Model 3	
Age of organisation	0.00	**	0.00	**	0.00	**
	(0.00)		(0.00)		(0.00)	
Budget Size						
Small	REF.		REF.		REF.	
Medium	0.79	***	0.59	***	0.58	***
	(0.13)		(0.12)		(0.12)	
Large	1.72	***	1.29	***	1.30	***
	(0.13)		(0.14)		(0.13)	
Program Service Area						
Arts & Culture	0.37	*	0.12		0.11	
	(0.15)		(0.14)		(0.15)	
Education	-0.11		0.02		0.04	
	(0.17)		(0.15)		(0.16)	
Environment / Animal	0.59	**	-0.10		-0.09	
	(0.22)		(0.20)		(0.20)	
Health	-0.19		-0.20		-0.19	
	(0.16)		(0.15)		(0.15)	
Human Services	REF.		REF.		REF.	
Community Improvement /						
Social Advocacy	-0.11		-0.23		-0.21	
	(0.19)		(0.18)		(0.19)	
Religious	-0.16		0.04		0.05	
	(0.20)		(0.20)		(0.19)	
Neighborhoods	0.89	**	0.69	*	0.73	*
	(0.33)		(0.30)		(0.30)	
Other	-0.17		-0.25		-0.28	
	(0.30)		(0.28)		(0.27)	
Past Participation						
No	REF.		REF.		REF.	
Yes	-0.15		-0.04		-0.04	

	(0.12)	(0.11)	(0.11)
Year			
2015	REF.	REF.	REF.
2020	-0.08 (0.12)	-0.34 ** (0.11)	-0.34 ** (0.11)
Network size (log of no. of likes)		0.23 *** (0.05)	0.23 *** (0.05)
Network activity (log of no. of posts)		0.32 *** (0.07)	0.31 *** (0.07)
Network engagement (log of no. of shares)		0.13 * (0.05)	0.15 ** (0.05)
Post Type			
Beneficiary			0.06 (0.26)
Goal			0.58 * (0.24)
Gratitude			0.47 * (0.20)
Mission			-0.19 (0.15)
Social Media			-0.88 (0.98)
Solicitation			REF.
Tie			0.10 (0.13)
Intercept	7.42 *** (0.12)	5.23 *** (0.31)	5.23 *** (0.31)
Number of observations	983	983	983
Adjusted R-squared	0.22	0.33	0.33
AIC	3562.48	3420.67	3419.67
BIC	3122.96	3250.09	3216.86

*Notes: Program service area is not globally statistically significant; budget size and post type are globally statistically significant. REF. = reference category *** $p < .001$, ** $p < .01$, * $p < .05$*

The results from model 3 are robust to using a different operationalization of post type: the raw counts of the number of times an organization made each post.

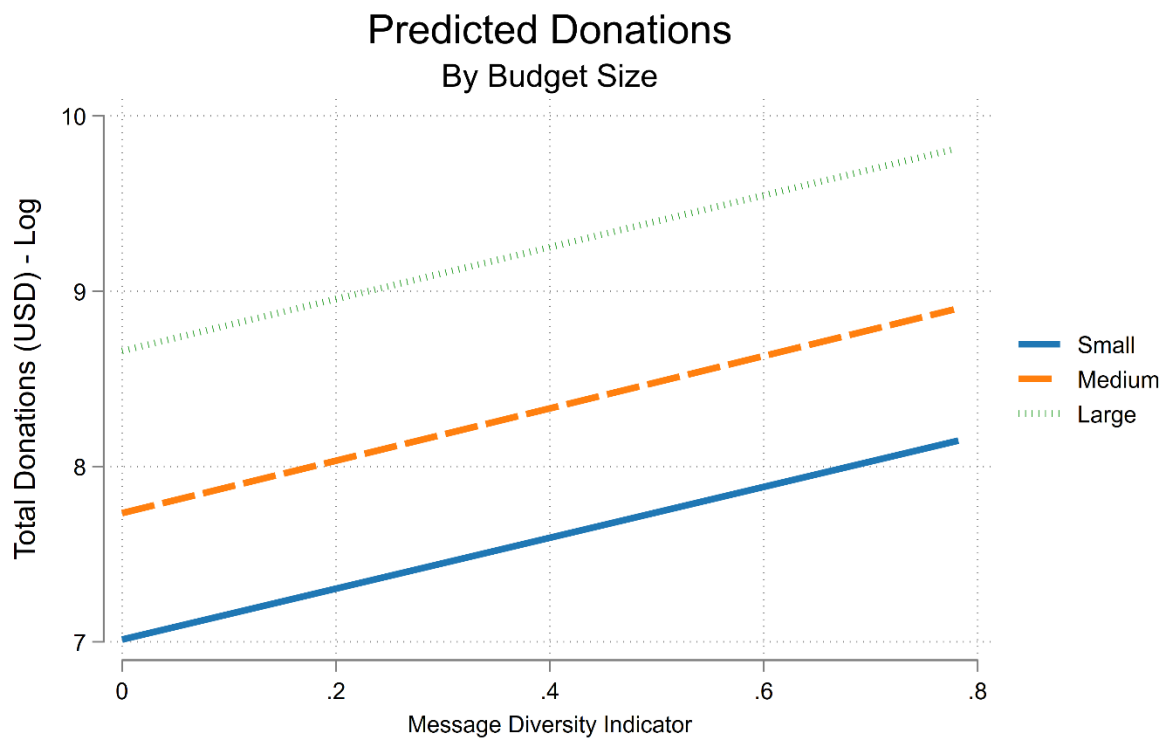
Model 4 replaces post type with post diversity. Model fit statistics are almost identical to Model 3, therefore we focus more on the substantive interpretation: nonprofits that post a variety of

fundraising message types on Facebook raise more in total donations than organizations that use homogenous messaging (98 percent more).

	Model 4	
Age of organisation	0.00 (0.00)	**
Budget Size		
Small	REF.	
Medium	0.59 (0.12)	***
Large	1.26 (0.14)	***
Program Service Area		
Arts & Culture	0.09 (0.15)	
Education	0.02 (0.15)	
Environment / Animal	-0.09 (0.20)	
Health	-0.19 (0.15)	
Human Services	REF.	
Community Improvement / Social Advocacy	-0.23 (0.18)	
Religious	0.08 (0.19)	
Neighborhoods	0.64 (0.30)	*
Other	-0.27 (0.28)	
Past Participation		
No	REF.	
Yes	-0.02 (0.11)	
Year		
2015	REF.	
2020	-0.38 (0.11)	**
Network size (log of no. of likes)	0.23 (0.05)	***
Network activity (log of no. of posts)	0.22 (0.08)	**
Network engagement (log of no. of shares)	0.11	*

Diversity of post type	(0.05)	
	0.67	**
Intercept	(0.22)	
	5.22	***
Number of observations	(0.30)	
	981	
Adjusted R-squared		0.33
AIC		3406.44
BIC		3243.670

Finally, we consider the potential moderating effect of budget size on the association between message diversity and fundraising success. Using model 4, we see consistency in the association between message diversity and fundraising success: the expected increase in donations is similar across nonprofit budget size (Figure 1).



Source: Omaha Gives 2015, 2020 data; n=981.

Figure 1. Association between predicted donations and message diversity, by budget size

Discussion

This study adds to the fundraising literature by demonstrating the relationship between the content and diversity of social media messages and attracting donations. Our findings suggest that mixing different types of fundraising messages on social media is positively associated with higher levels of donations: nonprofits with more diverse fundraising posts raise 98 percent more in donations during Omaha Gives. We also examined whether the main type of message posted on Facebook - such as goal setting, gratitude, discussing the mission of the organization and general solicitation – was associated with fundraising success. The picture is mixed but compared to general solicitation messages, nonprofits that mainly posted messages of gratitude or goal attainment raised more during the events; for other post types there was no significant difference with general solicitation messages in the amount raised. The variable overall is statistically significant, indicating that message type is an important explanatory factor of fundraising performance during online giving events. This coheres with expectations from the literature, as diverse messaging targets different types of potential donors who might be motivated to give based on emotional or efficacy framing (Bekkers & Wieking, 2011).

We highlight a number of other key findings. First, we find a range of differences – in degree of association and statistical significance - in expected donations by Facebook post type; overall the variable is globally significant, suggesting there are statistically significant differences across the post types overall. Compared to posts where the general aim is solicitation, those that focus on

thanking or displaying gratitude towards donors are associated with an increase in donations (Li et al., 2020; Waters & Feneley, 2013). One of the organizations in our dataset posted following Facebook message thanking their donors:

Thank you to over 126 different individuals who have made contributions already and received their personal calls of thanks from our Executive Director!

In addition, many organizations posted the names of their donors. Coupled with our findings, this suggests that donors are more likely to give in online fundraising events when organizations nurture relationships by showing gratitude. As argued previously by Lacetera et al. (2016), mentioning specific donors in their gratitude posts can create peer effects among the organization's/donors' social media networks.

Second, our results suggest that posts calling on followers to take action on behalf of the organization, such as changing their profile picture on Facebook, are associated with a 58 percent decrease in donations. This finding resonates with Lovejoy & Saxton's (2012) three-tier "hierarchy of engagement" model – information, community, and action. Often it is assumed that "action" is the most important part of messaging as it urges donors to do something like share content or change their profile picture. However, in the context of fundraising during online giving days, such calls to action appear least effective among the variety of message types and strategies a nonprofit could adopt.

This study uses data from a single social media platform (Facebook) and thus overlooks fundraising activities conducted on other platforms such as X (formerly Twitter), TikTok, etc. We suspect that the effect of message diversity and type is consistent across platforms, but we do not show this empirically. We also do not observe offline/non-social media fundraising activities of the organization such as its supporters in the community, board members' engagement in fundraising, or solicitation through mail or emails. We encourage future researchers to develop more robust models capturing both offline and online fundraising activities of nonprofit organizations.

Conclusion

Overall, we found that mixing different types of social media posts is more likely to achieve fundraising success. We also found that organizations that mainly posted about gratitude or goal attainment raised more during the event as compared to general solicitation messages. This suggest that message time is important factor predicting fundraising success using social media. In addition, we showed how the benefit of more diverse messaging is the same for nonprofits of varying budget sizes, lending weight to the argument that social media platforms can be effective mechanisms for generating donations for smaller organizations with limited staffing.

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